

1 LiTRE Reading Workshop Program

MODULE 1: FOUNDATION

PRE-TEST

Current State of Reading in South African Schools

The Problem

Introduction to the LiTRE Method

Why LiTRE was developed

What is LiTRE



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop

SESSION 1: Program

08:30 To 10:00 (90 min)



2 Is there a crisis in reading in SA?

TRUE (Crisis Exists)



FALSE (No Crisis)



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop PRE-TEST
READING CRISIS IN RSA



3

Survey Results for Question 1

Q: Is there a crisis in reading in SA?

TRUE (Crisis Exists) 04

FALSE (No Crisis) 16



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop PRE-TEST
SURVEY RESULTS



4

Current state of Reading in South African Schools

In short: South Africa's primary schools are in the midst of a **foundational literacy crisis**, with English reading deeply affected.

- **Early literacy is foundational:** If children cannot read fluently by Grade 3, they struggle with all later subjects, including Mathematics and Science.
- **Systemic consequences:** Poor reading outcomes lead to **grade repetition, dropout rates, and long-term unemployment.**



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[2030 Reading Panel's 2026 report](#)



5

THE PROBLEM

Can the process of blending letters be made concrete, visible and memorable enough for a learner to experience how a word is constructed?



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop LiTRE
Can LiTRE solve this problem?



6

The Root Cause

What is the biggest contributor to the reading crisis?

- A) Lack of resources/books
- B) Overcrowded classrooms
- C) Language barriers (HL vs English)
- D) Outdated teaching methods



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop Cause
Reasons



I LEARN TO READ ENGLISH

— USING THE — **LITRE** METHOD

*A practical catch-up approach
to English reading*

7



Programme Introduction

Equipping teachers with a simple, visual and practical method to help learners read with confidence.

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8

Why LiTRE was developed

I worked with a 14 year old Grade 7 learner who was unable to read and do simple math. I started by creating a meaningful story based on the learner's own experience. The learner was able to read the familiar story with increasing confidence after many trials.

When the individual words were removed from the story and presented independently, he failed to read them. This pointed to **familiarity and memorisation not reading**.

After working with another learner, using the newly developed **LiTRE** method, I observed that the learner was **breaking words down and reconstructing them through blending**.



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop Introduction
Equipping teachers with a visual and practical method
to help learners read with confidence.



9 WHAT IS LITRE?

LITRE is a practical catch-up reading method that helps learners build the confidence and skills to read English words.

LITRE is:



VISUAL

Learners see and use a clear visual model.



PRACTICAL

Learners do the activities with their hands and voice.



PARTICIPATORY

Learners participate, practise and repeat.



STRUCTURED

A step-by-step sequence from letters to reading words.

From Letters to Reading



Story



See



Do



Blend



Read



LITRE = Learn • Introduce • Teach • Repeat • Encourage

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MODULE 2: PRACTICAL

Draw the Palm

The English Family

Who is Leaving HOME?

Introducing The Vowels

The LiTRE Blending Machine

Draw the Palm



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop

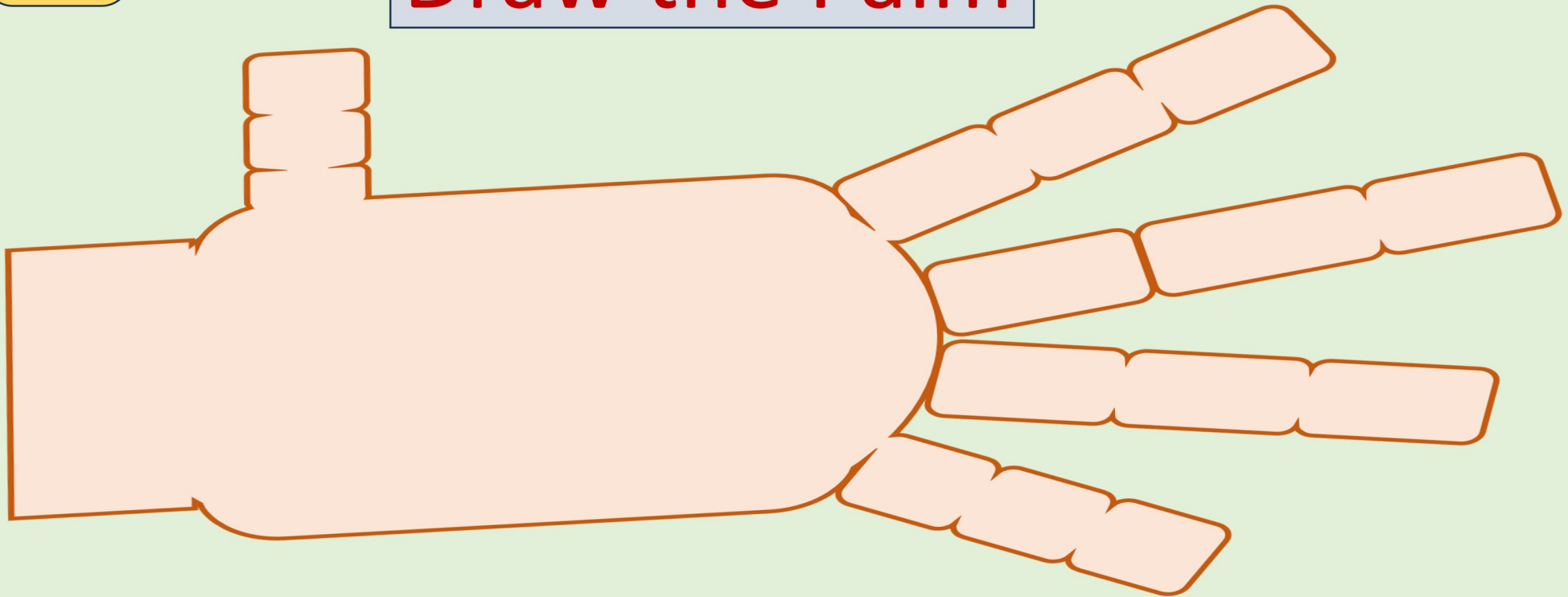
SESSION 2: Program

10:15 To 12:15 (120 min)



11

Draw the Palm

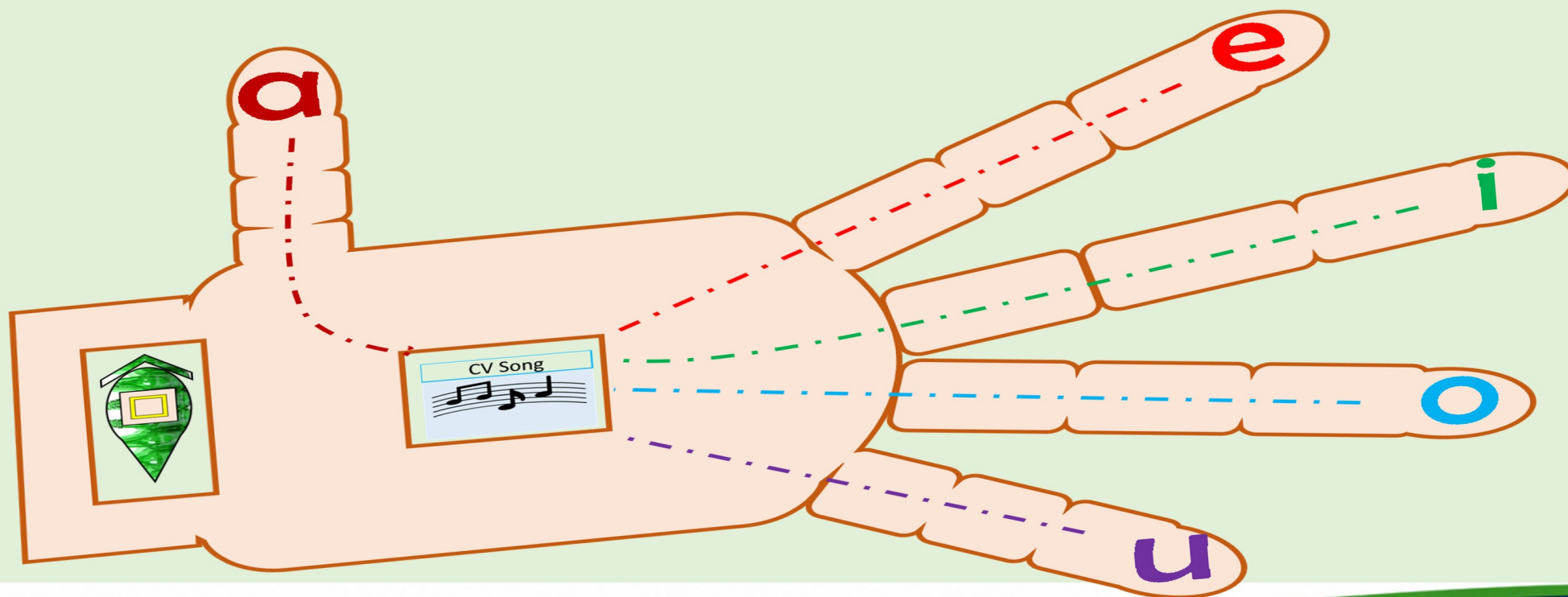


SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop PRACTICALS
Making the Blending Machine- Part 1

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12

Who is Leaving HOME ?



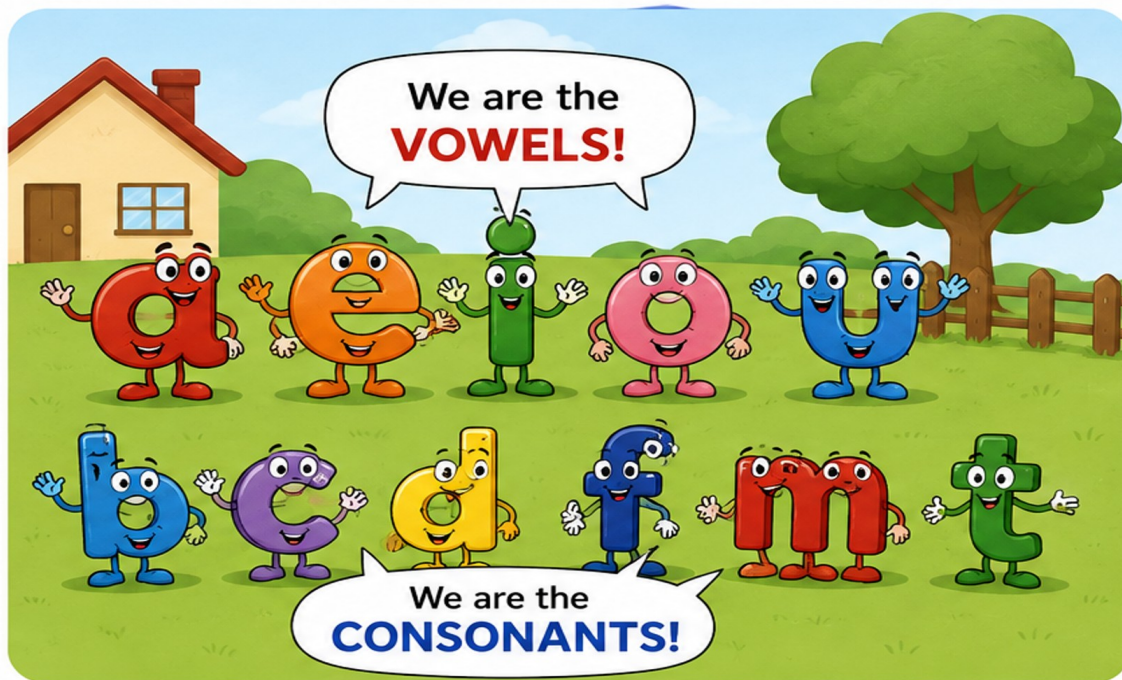
SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop PRACTICALS
Nano Blending Machine (NBM)- Part 2

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13

THE ENGLISH FAMILY

We learn the letters through a fun story about the English Family.



Why use a story?



It makes learning **memorable**.



It creates **interest** and **connection**.



It helps learners **recognise** and **remember** the letters.



It **prepares** learners for practical reading activities.



Teacher Focus: Use the story to introduce the letters. Make it fun, visual and interactive.

14

Tactile Engagement: Consonant Flashcards

1. **Fold:** Take a blank A4 page and fold it in half (long edges touching). Fold it in half again, and then a third time to get exactly 8 equal pieces per page.
2. **Cut:** Repeat this with 3 to 4 pages, then cut along the folded lines.
3. **Write:** Use a marker to write each letter A to Z on a separate card. You have just made your own physical teaching aid to take back to your classroom!



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop Using the Blender

Litre Sign Language Game

15

Litre Sign Language Game 1

3-Hand Words: po-ta-to, to-ma-to,
ba-na-na, pa-pa-ya, do-mi-no

2-Hand Words: ba-by, he-ro, ze-ro,
pa-per, ti-ger

1-Hand Words: me, he, she, we, to, do



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop Using the Blender

Who is leaving home?

16

Litre Sign Language Game 2

English: ba-by, he-ro, po-ta-to, ba-na-na

Indigenous (Nguni): bo-na (see), ba-la

(count), i-ka-ti (cat), u-mu-ntu (person)



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop Using the Blender

Who is leaving home?

17 INTRODUCING THE VOWELS

The vowels are the heart of the LITRE Method.

We introduce the vowel group.



SEE

Learners see the vowel letters.



SAY

Learners say the sounds together.



REMEMBER

Learners remember the vowels.

The Vowel Group



- a** as in **apple**
- e** as in **elephant**
- i** as in **igloo**
- o** as in **orange**
- u** as in **umbrella**



Teacher Demonstration: Show the vowels in their positions on the LITRE palm. Say the sounds clearly.

18

Kinesthetic Memory Activation

- Stand up! Take 5 small hops forward.
- On each hop, loudly pronounce the next vowel.

A E I O U



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop Learning Vowels

Hopping activity

19

Game 2: The Number Map

Pair Up!

Partner A calls out a random number.

Partner B must instantly shout the corresponding vowel.

Then switch!

1=A

2=E

3=I

4=O

5=U



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop Learning Vowels

N u m b e r M a p

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20 THE LITRE BLENDING MACHINE

The palm is the meeting place where letters come together to make a sound.



PALM = MEETING PLACE
All letters come together here.



VOWELS = FIXED POSITIONS
The vowels stay in their places.



CONSONANTS = COME IN
Consonants move in to meet the vowels.



BLEND = MAKE THE SOUND
Letters blend together to make a sound.



READ = SAY THE WORD
The blended sound becomes a word we can read.



Key Idea: See the letters • Bring together • Blend • Read
Practice often. Repetition builds reading confidence.

21 LiTRE Reading Workshop Program

MODULE 3: ORAL

Letter **t** meets **vowels**

Letter m meets vowels

My first 6 letter word

Letter p meets vowels

Catch Up Classroom Use

Your Classroom Activity

MODULE 4: APPLICATION

Ait's Reading Program (30 min)

Assessment and Feedback

Reflection

POST - TEST

Programme Evaluation

Thank You /Completion



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SESSION 3: Program

13:00 To 15:00 (120 min)



22

Letter **t** meets vowels

Blend t and vowels		Sounds like
ta	as in ta in	ta ta
te	as in	tea
ti	as in	tie
to	as in	toe
tu	as in	too



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop Using the Blender

letter **t** meets **vowels**

23

Letter **m** meets **vowels**

<u>ma</u>	a person's mother
<u>me</u>	the objective case of the first-person pronoun I
mi	a musical note
<u>mo</u>	a moment
<u>mu</u>	a Greek letter



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop Using the Blender

m meets **vowels**

24

My first 6 letter word

BLEND			to	WITH			ma	WITH			to
ta	ma	ta	→								
te	me	te									
ti	mi	ti									
to	mo	to									
tu	mu	tu	→								

to ma to = tomato



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop Reading a 6-letter word

to ma to

25

Letter **p** meets vowels

Blend p and vowels		Sounds like
pa	as in	pa
pe	as in	pee
pi	as in	pie
po	as in	poe
pu	as in	poo



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop Using the Blender

letter p meets **vowels**

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26

Catch-Up Classroom Use

Support struggling readers with the LITRE Method.



1. Identify Difficulty

- Listen to the learner read.
- Note where blending or word reading breaks down.
- Identify specific sounds, blends or patterns causing difficulty.



2. Practise Systematically

- Use the palm model for blending practice.
- Start with simple C-V combinations.
- Move to blends, then to words, then short sentences.
- Keep practice short, focused and daily.



3. Monitor Progress

- Check improvement regularly.
- Celebrate small gains.
- Adjust activities to the learner's needs.
- Keep records of words read and understood.



Goal: Help every struggling reader catch up step by step and experience success.

Key Reminders



Short, daily practice works best.



Individual or small group support.



Consistency and encouragement build confidence.



Every learner can improve with the right support.

27

Your Classroom Activity

Put the LITRE Method into practice with your learners.



1. Choose a Learner Group

- Select a small group or individual learners who need support.
- Consider their reading level and specific difficulties.
- Plan a short, focused session.



2. Select an Activity

- Choose a blending or reading activity from the worksheets.
- Match the activity to the learners' needs.
- Prepare the materials you will need.



3. Demonstrate

- Model the activity using the palm model.
- Show the sequence clearly.
- Let learners watch, then try together.



4. Assess

- Observe learners during the activity.
- Check understanding and accuracy.
- Give feedback and note next steps.

Key Reminders



Be focused and intentional.



Keep activities short, engaging and practical.



Observe closely and listen carefully.



Encourage effort and celebrate small successes.



Adjust and plan the next step.



LITRE Method

Every sound. Every blend. Every learner.

You teach. They practise. They read. They succeed.

28

Assessment

Check understanding, practise skills, apply in class.



1. Knowledge

- Answer short questions about the LITRE Method.
- Identify vowels, consonants and blends.
- Explain the sequence of the palm model.
- Complete a short quiz.



2. Practical Demonstration

- Use the palm model to blend C–V combinations.
- Blend to form words and read them.
- Follow the sequence correctly.
- Work with your partner and demonstrate.



3. Classroom Application

- Plan a short activity for a learner group.
- Demonstrate how you will teach it.
- Explain how you will assess and monitor progress.
- Share and receive feedback.



Goal: Show that you can understand, use and apply the LITRE Method with confidence.



LITRE Method

Every sound. Every blend. Every learner.

Key Reminders



Understand the method.



Practise the skills.



Apply in your classroom.



Assess and give feedback.



Monitor and track progress.

Good assessment builds strong readers.

29

Reflection

Take a moment to think and plan ahead.



1. What did I learn?

- What was new to me?
- What skills did I practise?
- What will help my learners the most?



2. How will I use it?

- How will I use the LITRE Method in my classroom?
- Which learners will benefit first?
- What is my next step?



3. My Action Plan

- Try one activity this week.
- Practise daily for a few minutes.
- Monitor and celebrate progress.



Remember: Every small step makes a big difference for our learners.



LITRE Method
Every sound. Every blend. Every learner.

Reflect. Plan. Act. Make a difference.

30

Thank You / Completion

You have completed the workshop!



Congratulations!

You are now equipped to use the LITRE Method to build strong readers.



What's Next?

- Use the palm model every day.
- Practise blending and reading.
- Use the worksheets to reinforce learning.
- Monitor progress and celebrate success.



You make a difference!

Your teaching helps learners discover the joy of reading.



Thank you for your time, participation and commitment!

Together, we build confident readers.



LITRE Method
Every sound. Every blend. Every learner.

Every sound. Every blend. Every learner.

31

Do you know how to pronounce
the word **ISLE** ?

A: Yes. the letter L is silent



B: Yes. the letter E is silent



SACE-CPTD Reading Workshop
PRONUNCIATION
SILENT LETTERS

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